MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION April 2026SECOND SEMESTER

Skill Development Components (SDC) **- MG2SDCBAJ101 - DIGITAL JOURNALISM AND FACT CHECKING**

(2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes Maximum Marks: 50

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answers

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. State the year in which AIR adopted the name Akashvani.
Ans: 1957

2. List any four purposes served by books.
Ans: Education, information, entertainment, knowledge preservation

3. Explain the different forms of hacking recognized under the IT Act.
Ans: Unauthorized access, data theft, identity theft, system damage, white hat, black hat, grey hat hacking

4. Explain the nature of misinformation.
Ans: False or inaccurate information spread without harmful intent

5. Recognize the credibility feature of television in news broadcasting.
Ans: Audio-visual authenticity and live coverage

6. State the risks of AI in news production.
Ans: Bias, misinformation, deepfakes, job displacement

7. State two elements of the misinformation ecosystem.
Ans: Creators and disseminators

8. Define piracy in the digital context.
Ans: Unauthorized copying and distribution of digital content

9. Outline the purpose of the Press Information Bureau.
Ans: Disseminates official government information; Press Information Bureau communicates policies to media

10. Describe the basic tools used for verifying online videos.
Ans: Reverse image search, metadata check, geolocation tools

11. Explain the concept of content personalization using AI.
Ans: AI delivers customised content based on user data and behaviour

12. Describe the significance of the amendment to the IT Act.
Ans: Enhances cyber security, data protection, and control of digital crimes

Part B

Short Essay

Answer any **5** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

13. State the limitations associated with Mobile Journalism.

Ans: Mobile Journalism (MoJo) has several limitations despite its convenience. It faces technical constraints such as limited battery life, storage, and lower production quality compared to professional equipment. There are issues with audio and video quality, especially in noisy or low-light environments. Journalists may lack advanced editing tools on mobile devices. It also raises concerns about credibility and verification, as quick reporting may lead to errors. Additionally, MoJo journalists often face safety risks, network dependency, and lack of institutional support, which can affect the depth and reliability of reporting.

14. Classify different types of biases that influence digital media consumption.

Ans: Digital media consumption is influenced by various biases. Confirmation bias leads users to prefer information that supports their existing beliefs. Algorithmic bias occurs when platforms show content based on past behaviour. Selection bias limits exposure to diverse viewpoints. Cultural and social bias shape interpretation based on background. Framing bias influences how information is presented, and availability bias makes people rely on easily accessible information. These biases create echo chambers and filter bubbles, restricting balanced understanding.

15. Outline the objectives and focus areas of the Digital India Programme.

Ans: The Digital India Programme aims to transform India into a digitally empowered society and knowledge economy. Its objectives include providing digital infrastructure as a core utility, ensuring governance and services on demand, and promoting digital literacy. Key focus areas are broadband connectivity, e-governance, digital payments, cybersecurity, and skill development. It also encourages innovation, startup culture, and inclusion of rural populations in the digital ecosystem.

16. Describe how algorithmic amplification supports the spread of manipulated content.

Ans: Algorithmic amplification refers to how digital platforms promote content based on engagement metrics such as likes, shares, and comments. Manipulated content often spreads quickly because it is sensational, emotional, or controversial, attracting more interaction. Algorithms prioritise such content, increasing its visibility and reach. This leads to the rapid spread of misinformation, fake news, and propaganda, often without proper verification. As a result, users are exposed to biased or misleading information, reinforcing echo chambers and polarisation.

17. Outline the major platforms used in online news dissemination.

Ans: Online news is disseminated through multiple platforms, including news websites and portals, social media platforms (Facebook, X, Instagram), mobile news apps, blogs and independent journalism sites, and video platforms like YouTube. Messaging apps such as WhatsApp and Telegram also play a major role in news sharing. These platforms enable instant, wide, and interactive distribution of news content.

18. Identify the technical competencies necessary in online journalism.

Ans: Online journalists require several technical skills, including digital writing and editing, multimedia production (audio, video, graphics), and basic photography and videography. They must be skilled in content management systems (CMS), social media handling, and SEO (Search Engine Optimization). Knowledge of data journalism, fact-checking tools, and analytics is also essential. Additionally, they need adaptability to new technologies and digital tools.

19. Summarize the steps involved in verifying a viral photograph.

Ans: Verifying a viral photograph involves several steps. First, conduct a reverse image search to find the original source. Check the metadata for details like date and location. Analyse the image for visual inconsistencies or manipulation. Verify the context by cross-checking with reliable news sources. Use geolocation tools to confirm the location. Finally, consult fact-checking websites to ensure authenticity before sharing.

20. Describe common techniques used to manipulate textual information.

Ans: Textual information can be manipulated in various ways. Selective editing or omission can distort meaning. Misleading headlines (clickbait) attract attention but misrepresent content. Use of emotional or loaded language influences reader perception. False attribution or fake quotes create misinformation. Context manipulation presents information out of context, and fabrication of facts or statistics misleads audiences. These techniques are often used to influence opinions and spread propaganda.

Part C

Essay

Answer any **1** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

21. Identify the structural and technical elements involved in web content creation and editing.

Ans: Web content creation and editing involve both structural and technical elements. Structurally, content must have a clear headline, subheadings, introduction, body, and conclusion for readability. It should follow logical flow, coherence, and proper formatting such as bullet points and short paragraphs. Technically, it requires knowledge of Content Management Systems (CMS), HTML basics, and Search Engine Optimization (SEO) techniques like keyword usage and meta descriptions. Other elements include multimedia integration (images, videos, infographics), hyperlinking, and mobile responsiveness. Editing involves proofreading, fact-checking, grammar correction, and plagiarism checking to ensure accuracy, clarity, and credibility.

22. Explain the stages involved in debunking fake news systematically.

Ans: Debunking fake news involves a systematic process. First is identification, where suspicious content is recognized. Next is verification, using tools like reverse image search,

metadata analysis, and source checking. The third stage is cross-checking, where information is compared with credible news sources and fact-checking websites. Then comes analysis, identifying bias, manipulation, or misleading context. After that, evidence collection is done to support the correction. Finally, correction and dissemination involve clearly presenting the verified facts to the public to counter misinformation. This process ensures accuracy, transparency, and public awareness.

23. Reproduce the performance features of traditional media.

Ans: Traditional media such as newspapers, radio, and television have distinct performance features. They are considered highly credible and authoritative, especially in news dissemination. They follow structured and professional editorial processes, ensuring accuracy and reliability. Traditional media provide wide reach and mass audience coverage, particularly in regional and rural areas. They maintain fixed schedules and formats, offering consistency and discipline in content delivery. Additionally, they support cultural preservation, public awareness, and educational functions. However, they are generally one-way communication systems, with limited audience interaction compared to digital media.